BRIGHTSTEPS INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

Mockeyville, Grand-Bassam, Côte d'Ivoire

Life Skills Unit Plans

Life Skills

Pre-K and Kindergarten

Pre-Kindergarten · Kindergarten (taught together)

2026 – 2027 · Six modules · 18 lessons · Alternate Fridays with SEL

Companion to the Life Skills Scope and Sequence 2026–2027

Internal planning document · October 2026

How to Use These Plans

Pre-K and Kindergarten, taught together · 20-minute Life Skills Friday · six modules of three lessons. Life Skills alternates with SEL on Fridays. Plan one lesson for the whole group; the differentiation line gives the expected outcome for Pre-K and for Kindergarten. Children learn by doing: talk is short, and most of each lesson is hands-on practice with real basins, jugs, cloths and clothes. Materials are free, recycled or cost a few hundred francs at the market. Pre-Nursery has its own, simpler plans.

This year only. About 14 Life Skills Fridays remain from late October. Teach lessons 1 and 2 of every module, and lesson 3 when time allows. If a Friday is lost, merge lessons rather than skip a module.

- **Puppet friend.** The same puppet from SEL can visit every lesson. It makes the mistake; the children fix it.
- **Small groups.** For water, pouring and planting, work in groups of four to six with an adult while the others practise on the mat.
- **Short steps.** Show one step, then children copy straight away. Use a gesture or a picture card for every step.
- **Any answer counts.** Children may answer by pointing or showing. Record Kindergarten words exactly.
- **Safety.** Pre-K never handles real coins; they use large card coins. Kindergarten may handle real 25, 50 and 100 FCFA coins only with close adult supervision. Beans and other small objects are handed to Pre-K one to one. Plastic knives on soft fruit only. Cleaning products and medicines are shown as pictures, never handled. Outdoor games happen in the shade with water nearby.
- **Allergies.** Check every child's allergies before any lesson with food. Show peanuts (arachides) as pictures only.

Evidence. Each child has a Life Skills Passport. When a child shows a skill, stamp or sign it at one of three levels: **Not yet · With help · On my own**. Children may show one skill, such as handwashing, at Student Led Conferences.

Internal planning document. In anything families see, describe the approach as inquiry-based learning.

Class materials kit: the puppet friend; two plastic basins, a plastic jug, small jugs and cups, bar soap; a demo toothbrush and old toothbrushes from families; reusable plastic plates, cups and spoons; a dressing-up basket of big shirts with large buttons and jackets; chalk; printed picture cards, card coins and passports; dried beans and soil. Free and recycled: egg cartons, plastic bottles and yoghurt pots, cardboard boxes, newspapers, pagne scraps and cloth squares, odd socks, clean empty packets and sachets, leaves and fruit peels.

Module 1 · Taking Care of Me

Goals. Pre-K: washes hands with picture prompts; brushes with help; puts on shoes and jacket. Kindergarten: washes hands alone in six steps for 20 seconds; brushes for two minutes; does up buttons and puts shoes on the right feet; coughs into the elbow.

Lesson 1 · Germ Busters (20 min)

Materials: puppet, basin, jug of clean water, bar soap, a cloth or paper towel per child, a little cooking oil and flour (pretend germs; check for wheat allergy), six-step picture strip.

1. **Circle (3 min).** Sing the hello song, naming every child. Show your hands: «Are our hands clean? Germs are so small we cannot see them.»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet comes back from the playground and grabs a mango: «I'm hungry!» Rub a little oil and flour on its hands: «Look, these are pretend germs. What must our friend do first?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Show the six rubbing steps dry, with the picture strip: *palms*, *backs*, *in between the fingers*, *knuckles*, *thumbs*, *fingertips*. Sing slowly to the tune of «Frère Jacques»: «Palms and backs, palms and backs, / In between, in between, / Knuckles, thumbs and fingers, knuckles, thumbs and fingers, / Clean, clean, clean! Clean, clean, clean!» Twice through is about 20 seconds.
4. **Practise (8 min).** *Basin:* groups of four come to the basin. Put a dab of «germs» on each child's hands. An adult pours from the jug; children wet, soap, rub through the six steps singing the song twice, rinse and dry. «Are the germs gone?» *Mat:* the others do the six steps dry with the song and teach the puppet.
5. **Close (2 min).** «When do we wash our hands?» Model answers: before eating, after the toilet, after playing outside.

Differentiation. Pre-K: does the steps following the picture strip, with reminders. Kindergarten: does all six steps alone for the whole song and says two times to wash.

Check. Stamp *I wash my hands in six steps.* Watch for thumbs and fingertips; these are the steps most often missed.

Tip. Stick the six-step picture strip above the class basin and sing the song at every snack time this module.

Lesson 2 · Shiny Teeth (20 min)

Materials: puppet, egg cartons (one cup per tooth), washable brown paint dabbed on the carton teeth as «food bits», old toothbrushes from families (labelled, for cartons only), a cup of water per pair, sand timer or the brushing song, demo toothbrush.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. Everyone gives a big smile and shows their teeth.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet holds its cheek: «My tooth hurts! I ate sweets all day and I forgot to brush.» Ask: «How can we help our friend?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Brush the egg-carton teeth: small circles on the front, then the back, then the tops where we chew. Say: «We brush two times a day: in the morning and at bedtime. We brush for two minutes. Then we spit.» Children copy the circles in the air.
4. **Practise (9 min).** In pairs, children dip a brush in water and scrub the paint off the carton teeth, front, back and tops, while the sand timer runs or the class sings the brushing song. Then everyone «air brushes» their own teeth with a finger for two minutes: top teeth, bottom teeth, front, back, spit.
5. **Close (2 min).** «When do we brush?» «Morning and night!» «For how long?» «Two minutes!» The puppet smiles with clean teeth.

Differentiation. Pre-K: brushes the front and back of the carton teeth with help; says «morning and night». Kindergarten: brushes front, back and tops for the full two minutes and tells the steps in order.

Check. Stamp *I know how to brush my teeth*. Note who brushes all three surfaces.

Tip. Never use the carton toothbrushes in a mouth, and never share a toothbrush. Wash the cartons and keep them for revision.

Lesson 3 · Getting Dressed (20 min)

Materials: puppet, dressing-up basket with big shirts with large buttons and jackets or cardigans, children's own shoes, half-sticker pairs for shoes, tissues and a bin.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. «Who got dressed by themselves this morning?»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet arrives with its shoes on the wrong feet, its shirt buttoned wrong and its jacket inside out. «Is something wrong? Can you help?» Children point and fix it.
3. **Teach (4 min).** *Buttons:* «Find the hole. Push the button halfway through. Pull it from the other side.» *Shoes:* put them side by side; the stickers inside make one picture when they are on the right feet. *Jacket flip:* lay the jacket on the floor, collar at your feet, arms in, flip it over your head. *Cough:* the puppet sneezes: «Atchoo! Cough or sneeze into your elbow.» Everyone copies.
4. **Practise (9 min).** Three stations, three minutes each: *buttons* on big shirts; *shoes* off and on the right feet; *jacket flip*. Every so often the puppet calls «Atchoo!» and everyone coughs into their elbow.
5. **Close (2 min).** Everyone shows one thing they did by themselves today. Throw used tissues in the bin and wash hands.

Differentiation. Pre-K: puts on shoes and the jacket with the flip; does one big button with help. Kindergarten: does up three buttons, puts shoes on the right feet alone and coughs into the elbow without a reminder.

Check. Stamp *I dress myself* and *I cough into my elbow*.

Tip. Ask families for old adult shirts with big buttons; they are easier for small fingers than uniforms.

Home practice. Let your child show you the six handwashing steps before dinner and brush for two minutes, morning and night.

Module 2 · Healthy Body

Goals. Pre-K: sorts food pictures into everyday and sometimes foods; chooses water. Kindergarten: says why everyday foods, water, active play and sleep help us grow.

Lesson 1 · Everyday Foods and Sometimes Foods (20 min)

Materials: puppet, picture cards of local foods (drawn, printed or cut from packets), a big basket marked *every day* and a small basket marked *sometimes*, a few pieces of banana or papaya on plastic plates. **Allergy check** before tasting; everyone washes hands first.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. «What did you eat this morning?»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet comes back from the market with a basket full of sweets, biscuits and soda: «I will eat this for breakfast, lunch and dinner!» Ask: «Is that a good idea?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Say: «Everyday foods give us energy to run and play, and help us grow and stay well. Sometimes foods are treats, for a party or a special day.» Show everyday cards: attiéké, poisson braisé, haricots, gombo, foutou, placali, egg, mangue, papaye, banane, ananas, orange, avocat, arachides. Show sometimes cards: sweets, biscuits, cake, soda, crisps, ice cream.
4. **Practise (8 min).** *Market sort:* each child takes two cards, names the food and puts it in a basket: «Attiéké is an everyday food.» *Pack the puppet's basket:* together, choose everyday foods for the puppet's day and leave one sometimes food «for Sunday».
5. **Taste and close (3 min).** Share the banana or papaya. «Is this an everyday food or a sometimes food?»

Differentiation. Pre-K: names the food and puts it in a basket with help. Kindergarten: sorts alone and says why: «It gives me energy.»

Check. Stamp *I sort everyday and sometimes foods.*

Tip. Say «everyday» and «sometimes», never «good» and «bad» foods, and never talk about body size. Peanuts stay as pictures only.

Lesson 2 · Water Is Best (20 min)

Materials: puppet, clean empty bottles and packets (water, soda, sweet juice drink), a small jug of clean drinking water per table, a cup per child with a rubber band as a fill line, trays, cloths, a picture of a happy tooth and a sad tooth. Children drink only water.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. Fan yourself: «Phew, it is hot today!»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet runs in from playing: «I'm so thirsty!» Hold up the water bottle and the soda bottle: «Which one should our friend drink?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Say: «When it is hot, our body needs water. Water is best. Sweet drinks have lots of sugar. Sugar can hurt our teeth.» Show the sad tooth. «Sweet drinks are sometimes drinks. Water is an everyday drink.»
4. **Practise (9 min).** *Pouring station:* at each table children hold the jug with two hands, pour slowly into their cup over the tray and stop at the line. Drink together: «Cheers! Water is best!» Wipe any drips with the cloth. *Drink sort:* children sort the empty bottles and packets into *every day* and *sometimes*.
5. **Close (2 min).** Check everyone's water bottle. «When will you drink water today?»

Differentiation. Pre-K: pours with two hands over the tray and chooses the water bottle. Kindergarten: pours to the line without spilling and says why water is best.

Check. Stamp *I choose water* and *I can pour*.

Tip. Bissap and juice drinks are usually sweetened; put them with the sometimes drinks unless they are made without sugar.

Lesson 3 · Busy Bodies, Sleepy Bodies (20 min)

Materials: puppet, small drum, a pagne for a pretend bed and mosquito net, bedtime picture cards (bath, pyjamas, brush teeth, toilet, story, under the net, lights out). Play outside in the shade with water nearby.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (2 min).** The puppet yawns and lies down: «I'm too tired to play. I stayed up very late.»
3. **Move (7 min).** *Animal moves:* fast drum, children run like a gazelle, hop like a frog or walk like a crab; drum stops, freeze; slow drum, crawl like a sleepy snail. After the game: «Put your hand on your chest. Can you feel your heart going fast?»
4. **Teach (3 min).** Say: «Moving and playing make our body strong. Sleep lets our body rest and grow. We need both, every day.»
5. **Practise (4 min).** Put the bedtime cards in order together. Children act each step and finish lying still under the pagne «net»: «Lights out. Goodnight.»
6. **Close (2 min).** Stay lying down, eyes closed, for a few quiet breaths. «What do you do before bed?»

Differentiation. Pre-K: joins the game and names one thing they do before bed. Kindergarten: puts four bedtime cards in order and says why we need sleep.

Check. Stamp *I know active play and sleep help me grow*.

Tip. Everyone drinks water after the game.

Home practice. Let your child choose water with a meal and tell you their bedtime routine.

Module 3 · Staying Safe

Goals. Pre-K: stops at the line and holds a hand; says «Don't touch, don't taste»; says their full name. Kindergarten: stops, looks and listens before crossing; knows medicines and cleaning products are not food; says their full name and a parent's name; goes near water only with an adult.

Lesson 1 · Stop, Look, Listen (20 min)

Materials: puppet, chalk, cardboard boxes or paper-plate steering wheels as «cars» and «motos», a ball. Draw a road with a kerb line and a crossing in a shaded part of the playground.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. «What do we see on the road near school?» Cars, motos, taxis, bicycles.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet kicks a ball and runs onto the chalk road after it. A child «car» drives up: «Beep beep!» Shout: «Stop! What should our friend do?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Model at the kerb line: «Stop at the line. Hold a grown-up's hand. Look left, look right, then left again. Listen for cars and motos. When the road is clear, walk across. Do not run.» Children copy each step with you.
4. **Practise (9 min).** Some children drive cardboard cars slowly along the road, saying «brrm». The others cross in pairs holding hands, or holding an adult's hand: stop at the line, look, listen, wait for the cars to pass, then walk. Swap roles. Throw the ball across once: «Can we run after it? No! We stop and ask a grown-up.»
5. **Close (2 min).** Chant with actions: «Stop, look, listen, hold a hand!»

Differentiation. Pre-K: stops at the line and holds a hand every time. Kindergarten: says «look left, right, then left again» and waits until the road is clear.

Check. Stamp *I stop, look and listen.*

Tip. Practise only on the chalk road, never near the real road. Leave the road drawn for free play this week.

Lesson 2 · The Safe Cupboard (20 min)

Materials: puppet, picture cards of medicines (tablets, syrup), cleaning products (bleach, washing powder, insect spray, a product in a reused water bottle) and foods and drinks (water, banane, bread, orange); a food basket; a box with a padlock drawing as the «safe cupboard», placed up high. Pictures only.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet finds a picture of bright tablets: «Ooh, sweets! Can I eat them?» Ask: «Are they sweets?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Say: «Medicines and cleaning products are not food. They can make us very sick. Only a grown-up gives us medicine. If you find something, don't touch, don't taste, tell a grown-up.» Teach the chant with actions: hands behind back, lips closed, point to an adult: «Don't touch, don't taste, tell a grown-up!»
4. **Practise (9 min).** *Sort:* each child takes a card and puts it in the food basket or gives it to you for the high safe cupboard. *Find and tell:* hide a few medicine and cleaning pictures around the room. A child who finds one does not pick it up; they say the chant and fetch an adult.
5. **Close (2 min).** «What do you do if you find a bottle or tablets?» Everyone does the chant.

Differentiation. Pre-K: sorts with help and uses the chant. Kindergarten: explains why a bottle without a label might not be water.

Check. Stamp *I know medicines and cleaning products are not food.*

Tip. Never bring real medicines or cleaning products to class, even empty containers. Remind families to keep them up high.

Lesson 3 · Who Am I? (20 min)

Materials: puppet, class list with each child's full name and the name of a parent or carer (from school records), a pretend market made from boxes and pagnes, pictures of safe helpers (police officer, a mother with children, a market seller, a teacher), pictures of the beach, the lagoon and a basin of water.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song, using every child's full name.
2. **Hook (2 min).** The puppet cries: «I was at the market with my maman and now I can't find her!»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Say: «If you are lost: stand still. Stay where you are. Ask a safe grown-up for help: a police officer, a mum with children, a market seller. Say your full name and your mum's or dad's name.» Model: «My name is Ama Kouassi. My mum is Awa Kouassi.»
4. **Practise (8 min).** *Name game:* each child says «My name is…» with their full name; Kindergarten adds «My mum (or dad, or grand-mère) is…». Whisper help from the class list. *Lost game:* children walk around the pretend market; when you call «Lost!», one child stands still, then goes to an adult «helper» and says both names.
5. **Water rule (2 min).** Show the beach, lagoon and basin pictures. «Can we go in the water by ourselves?» «No! Only with a grown-up.»
6. **Close (2 min).** The puppet finds its maman and says its full name to the class.

Differentiation. Pre-K: says own full name and points to a safe helper. Kindergarten: says own full name and a parent's name, and tells what to do if lost.

Check. One to one: stamp *I say my full name and a parent's name.* Follow the safeguarding policy and tell the Designated Safeguarding Lead about any disclosure.

Tip. Let each child name the grown-up who looks after them; not every child lives with a mum and dad.

Home practice. Help your child say their full name and your name; Kindergarten can start learning your phone number.

Module 4 · Helping at Home

Goals. Pre-K: matches plates and cups to a place mat; pours with two hands; folds a cloth in half; sorts socks by colour. Kindergarten: sets a place without help; pours and wipes a spill; washes a cup; folds in quarters and pairs socks.

Lesson 1 · Setting the Table (20 min)

Materials: puppet, plastic plates, cups, spoons and forks, pagne scraps as napkins, place mats made from cereal-box card with outlines of plate, cup, spoon and fork drawn on them, plain card mats for Kindergarten.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. «Who helps get the table ready at home?»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet sets the table: cup on the chair, plate upside down, spoon on the floor. «Dinner is ready!» Ask: «Can we eat like this?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Use an outline mat: «Plate in the middle. Fork on the left. Spoon on the right. Cup at the top. Napkin beside the fork.» Show carrying: «One thing at a time, two hands.»
4. **Practise (9 min).** Groups of four set a table for the puppet's family. Pre-K matches each item to its outline. Kindergarten counts: «Four people, four plates, four cups», then sets the plain mats. Check each other's places, then clear and stack.
5. **Close (2 min).** The puppet sits down to a tidy table: «Merci! Now we can eat.»

Differentiation. Pre-K: matches each item to the outline on the mat. Kindergarten: sets a place without an outline and counts the places.

Check. Stamp *I set the table.*

Tip. Laminate or tape over the card mats so they last the year.

Lesson 2 · Pour and Wipe (20 min)

Materials: small plastic jugs, cups with a fill line, trays, cloths or sponge squares, one basin of soapy water and one of clean water for washing cups, a drying cloth. Work outside or on a plastic sheet.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (2 min).** The puppet knocks over a cup of water and walks away. «Uh-oh! What should our friend do?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** *Pour:* «Two hands on the jug. Spout on the cup. Pour slowly. Stop at the line.» *Wipe:* «Oops! Get a cloth. Wipe. Squeeze it in the basin.» *Wash a cup:* rub inside and out in the soapy basin, rinse in the clean basin, stand it upside down to dry.
4. **Practise (10 min).** Three stations, about three minutes each: *pour* water from jug to cup; *wipe* the spills an adult makes on the tray; *wash* a cup in the two basins.
5. **Close (2 min).** «What do we say and do when we spill?» «Oops! Get a cloth!»

Differentiation. Pre-K: pours into a big cup and wipes with help. Kindergarten: pours to the line, wipes and squeezes the cloth, and washes a cup in two basins alone.

Check. Stamp *I pour and wipe* and *I wash a cup.*

Tip. Use the clean leftover water from the pouring station to water plants. Soapy water goes down the drain.

Lesson 3 · Fold and Sort (20 min)

Materials: puppet, a cloth square or pagne scrap per child, small towels, a basket of clean odd socks from families in many colours and sizes.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet tips out a laundry basket of tangled cloths and socks: «My maman asked me to tidy this. Help!»
3. **Teach (4 min).** *Fold:* «Edge to edge. Smooth it flat. Again, edge to edge.» *Socks:* «Find the same colour. Find the same size. Put them together and fold the top over.»
4. **Practise (9 min).** *Fold:* each child folds their cloth in half, then Kindergarten folds again into quarters; stack them in a neat pile. *Sock sort:* in teams, sort socks into colour piles on the mat, then find the pairs.
5. **Close (2 min).** Show the puppet the neat pile and the sock pairs. «Who will fold at home this week?»

Differentiation. Pre-K: folds in half and sorts socks by colour. Kindergarten: folds in quarters and pairs socks by colour and size.

Check. Stamp *I fold a cloth* and *I sort socks into pairs*.

Tip. Collect odd socks at the start of the module; families are glad to send them.

Home practice. Give your child one small job this week, such as setting the table or folding cloths.

Module 5 · Money Smart

Goals. Pre-K: pays with large card coins at a play market; tells needs from wants with pictures. Kindergarten: matches coins to picture prices; names real 25, 50 and 100 FCFA coins; saves tokens in a jar.

Lesson 1 · Shop at Our Market (20 min)

Materials: puppet, a market stall made from boxes and a pagne, fruit or clean empty packets to sell, picture price tags showing one, two or three coins, large card coins (bigger than a child's palm), small baskets or sacks.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. «Who goes to the market with their family? What do you buy?»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet takes a mango from the stall and walks off. The seller (you) calls: «Wait! You did not pay!»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Model: «Bonjour! One mango, please. How much?» Look at the tag: two coins. Count two card coins onto the tag. «Here you are.» «Merci!»
4. **Practise (9 min).** Half the class are sellers, half are shoppers. Each shopper has three card coins and buys one or two things by matching coins to the picture price. Swap roles halfway.
5. **Close (2 min).** Count all the card coins back into the box together. «What did you buy? How many coins did it cost?»

Differentiation. Pre-K: matches one coin to each coin on the tag. Kindergarten: buys two items and says how many coins are left.

Check. Stamp *I pay at the market.*

Tip. Make the card coins large so they cannot be swallowed, and count them in at the end of every lesson.

Lesson 2 · Coins We Use (20 min)

Materials: puppet with a small purse, large card coins for 25, 50 and 100 FCFA (drawn big, in the real colours), three small baskets; for Kindergarten only: real 25, 50 and 100 FCFA coins (one counted set per pair), a tray per pair, paper and crayons for rubbings.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet shakes its purse: jingle, jingle. «What is inside?» Take out the big card coins one by one.
3. **Teach (4 min).** Show the card 25, 50 and 100 coins. Point to the number and the colour on each. Say the rule: «Coins stay on the tray. Coins never go in our mouth, nose or ears.»
4. **Practise (9 min).** *Pre-K, with an adult on the mat:* sort big card coins into three baskets; play «Show me 50!» *Kindergarten, at a table with an adult close by:* count the real coins out onto the tray, sort them into 25, 50 and 100, match each to its card coin, and make a crayon rubbing of each.
5. **Close (2 min).** Kindergarten counts the real coins back into the box with the adult and checks the number. Everyone washes hands.

Differentiation. Pre-K: matches and names the card coins. Kindergarten: names real 25, 50 and 100 FCFA coins.

Check. Kindergarten: stamp *I name 25, 50 and 100 FCFA.* Pre-K: stamp *I sort coins.*

Tip. Pre-K never handles real coins. Any Kindergarten child who is not yet five uses card coins too. Count real coins out and in, and never leave them on a table.

Lesson 3 · Need It or Want It? (20 min)

Materials: puppet, picture cards of needs (water, food, clothes, a home, mosquito net, soap) and wants (toy car, sweets, balloon, doll, phone game), two baskets, a saving jar made from a clean plastic bottle with a slot cut by an adult, large card tokens.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet has one token: «I want a balloon! But I am thirsty and I need water. What should I buy?»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Say: «A need is something we must have to live and stay well. A want is something nice to have.» Show one need card and one want card.
4. **Practise (7 min).** Each child takes a card, says «Water is a need» or «A balloon is a want», and puts it in the right basket. Talk about any tricky cards together.
5. **Saving jar (2 min).** Each child posts a card token into the saving jar: «We save for later.»
6. **Close (2 min).** «What could our class save for?» Shake the jar and count the tokens together.

Differentiation. Pre-K: sorts with help. Kindergarten: sorts alone, explains why, and says what they would save for.

Check. Stamp *I tell a need from a want*.

Tip. Keep the saving jar out for the rest of the module; add a token for each kind act or tidy-up.

Home practice. Take your child to the market and let them help pay.

Module 6 · Caring for Our Planet

Goals. Pre-K: puts paper and plastic in the right bin; plants a bean with help; turns off the tap with a reminder. Kindergarten: sorts paper, plastic and food waste; plants and waters a bean alone; turns the tap off while soaping.

Lesson 1 · Which Bin? (20 min)

Materials: puppet, three boxes or sacks with picture labels (paper, plastic, food), clean collected rubbish (newspaper, cardboard, plastic bottles, clean water sachets, banana and orange peels, mango skins), a picture of plastic on the beach.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet drops a plastic bottle and walks on. Show the beach picture: «The wind blows rubbish to the lagoon and the beach. The fish and the crabs don't like it.»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Show the three bins and one item for each: «Paper here. Plastic here. Food here; food scraps can feed the soil.»
4. **Practise (9 min).** *Sorting relay:* two teams; one child at a time takes an item from the pile, says what it is made of and puts it in the right bin. Check the bins together and move anything in the wrong place.
5. **Close (2 min).** Everyone washes hands. «Where does a plastic bottle go?»

Differentiation. Pre-K: sorts paper and plastic. Kindergarten: sorts all three and names one thing in each bin.

Check. Stamp *I put rubbish in the right bin.*

Tip. Use only clean, dry items: no glass, no cans with sharp edges. Put the food scraps on the school garden or plants.

Lesson 2 · Plant a Bean (20 min)

Materials: puppet, bottoms of plastic bottles or yoghurt pots (cut by an adult, with drainage holes), soil, dried beans from the market, spoons, a jug of water, name labels, a few spare beans.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song.
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet shows a bean on its paw: «What is this? What will happen if we plant it?» Children guess.
3. **Teach (3 min).** Model: fill the cup with soil, poke a hole with a finger, drop in the bean, cover it, give it a little water. «A plant needs soil, water and sun.»
4. **Practise (10 min).** In groups of four at a table with an adult, each child spoons soil into their cup, makes a finger hole, takes one bean from the adult's hand, plants it, covers it and waters it. Stick on a name label. The others draw a bean plant on the mat.
5. **Close (2 min).** Put the cups by the window in the light. Choose watering helpers for the week.

Differentiation. Pre-K: plants with an adult beside them, one to one. Kindergarten: plants alone and says what a plant needs.

Check. Stamp *I plant a seed.* Look at the cups each Friday and talk about the roots and leaves.

Tip. Hand beans to Pre-K one at a time; never leave loose beans on the table. Plant a few spares in case some do not grow.

Lesson 3 · Save Water (20 min)

Materials: puppet, the class tap or a basin with a jug, bar soap, towels, a jug for collecting clean leftover water, the bean cups or school plants.

1. **Circle (2 min).** Hello song. «What do we use water for?»
2. **Hook (3 min).** The puppet washes its hands and leaves the tap running while it sings and soaps. Let a little water run: «Where does all that water go? Oh no, it is going down the drain!»
3. **Teach (4 min).** Say: «Water is precious. Wet your hands, tap off. Soap and rub with our song. Tap on to rinse. Tap off.» Then: «Clean water left in our cups can water our plants. Soapy water does not go on plants.»
4. **Practise (9 min).** *Tap off:* in groups at the tap or basin, children wash hands, turning the tap off (or putting the jug down) while they soap and sing. *Reuse:* the others pour the clean water left in their drinking cups into the collecting jug and water the bean cups and school plants.
5. **Close (2 min).** «When do we turn the tap off?» «When we soap!»

Differentiation. Pre-K: turns the tap off with a reminder. Kindergarten: turns it off alone and reminds a friend.

Check. Stamp *I turn the tap off while soaping*.

Tip. Put a small «tap off» picture beside the class tap.

Home practice. Ask your child to turn the tap off while soaping and to water a plant with leftover clean water.